

Word family: **complex / complexity / complexities**

Base word: complex

Part of speech: mainly **adjective** and **noun**

Related forms:

* **complex** (adj.) — 複雜的；由多個互相關聯部分組成的

* **complex** (n.) — 建築群；綜合設施；心理情結；複合體

* **complexity** (n.) — 複雜性

* **complexities** (plural n.) — 複雜之處；錯綜複雜的因素

* **complex number** — 複數

* **complex sentence** — 複合句

* **protein complex** — 蛋白質複合體

* **inferiority complex** — 自卑情結

* **superiority complex** — 優越情結

Useful expressions / extensions:

* **complex problem**

* **complex issue**

* **complex system**

* **complex relationship**

* **complex process**

* **highly complex**

* **increasingly complex**

* **complex of buildings**

* **shopping complex**

* **sports complex**

* **industrial complex**

* **residential complex**

* **inferiority complex**

* **superiority complex**

* **complexity of**

* **the complexities of**

* **complex number**

* **complex sentence**

* **complex carbohydrate**

Meaning in this passage

> As companies deal with increasingly **complex problems**, from product design to crisis management...

Here, **complex** means:

consisting of many connected factors or parts and therefore difficult to understand or solve
— 複雜的；錯綜複雜的

The problems companies face are not simple because they involve many interacting factors, people, decisions, and areas of expertise.

中文翻譯：

隨着公司需要處理愈來愈**複雜的問題**，由產品設計到危機管理.....

So here:

complex problem = 由多個互相關聯因素構成，因此難以分析或解決的問題

1. **complex (複雜的)** — 複雜的；錯綜複雜的

This is the exact sense used in your passage.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> Companies increasingly face **complex problems**.

公司愈來愈需要面對**複雜的問題**。

Practice 2

> This is a **complex issue** with no simple answer.

這是一個**複雜的議題**，沒有簡單答案。

Practice 3

> The situation is more **complex** than it first appears.

情況比最初看起來**複雜得多**。

MCQ-ready definition:

complex = 由很多互相關聯的部分、因素或問題組成，因此難以理解或處理

2. **complex problem** — 複雜問題

Practice 1

> Climate change is a highly **complex problem**.

氣候變化是一個高度**複雜的問題**。

Practice 2

> Complex problems often require several kinds of expertise.

複雜問題通常需要多方面的專業知識。

MCQ-ready definition:

complex problem = 涉及多個互相關聯因素，不能靠單一簡單方法解決的問題

3. **complex issue — 複雜議題**

Practice 1

> Workplace fairness is a **complex issue**.

職場公平是一個**複雜議題**。

Practice 2

> The report examines a number of **complex issues**.

報告探討了多個**複雜議題**。

MCQ-ready definition:

complex issue = 涉及不同立場、原因或因素，難以簡單判斷的議題

4. **complex system — 複雜系統**

Practice 1

> The human body is an extremely **complex system**.

人體是一個極其**複雜的系統**。

Practice 2

> Modern supply chains are highly **complex**.

現代供應鏈非常**複雜**。

MCQ-ready definition:

complex system = 由許多互相影響的部分組成的系統

5. **complex process — 複雜過程**

Practice 1

> Hiring is often a **complex process**.

招聘往往是一個**複雜的過程**。

Practice 2

> The application involves several **complex processes**.

申請涉及數個**複雜程序**。

MCQ-ready definition:

complex process = 包含多個步驟、因素或相互作用的過程

6. **complex relationship — 複雜關係**

Practice 1

> The two departments have a **complex relationship**.

兩個部門之間有一種**複雜的關係**。

Practice 2

> There is a **complex relationship** between stress and performance.

壓力與表現之間存在**複雜關係**。

MCQ-ready definition:

complex relationship = 受到多種互相影響因素塑造、難以簡單描述的關係

7. **increasingly complex** — 愈來愈複雜

Exactly the construction in your passage.

Practice 1

> Modern workplaces are becoming **increasingly complex**.

現代職場正變得**愈來愈複雜**。

Practice 2

> The project became **increasingly complex** as more teams joined.

隨着更多團隊加入，項目變得**愈來愈複雜**。

MCQ-ready definition:

increasingly complex = 隨時間或發展而變得愈來愈複雜

8. **highly complex** — 高度複雜的

Practice 1

> This is a **highly complex** technical problem.

這是一個**高度複雜的**技術問題。

Practice 2

> The organisation has a **highly complex** structure.

這個機構的架構**非常複雜**。

MCQ-ready definition:

highly complex = 涉及非常多元素或關係，因此特別難處理的

9. **complex** (noun : 建築群 / 綜合設施) — 建築群；綜合設施

A major distinct noun sense.

Practice 1

> The company moved into a new office **complex**.

公司搬進一個新的辦公室**建築群**。

Practice 2

> The hotel is part of a larger leisure **complex**.

酒店是一個大型休閒**綜合設施**的一部分。

MCQ-ready definition:

complex = 一組位於同一地方、互相關聯或有共同用途的建築或設施

10. **shopping complex** — 購物綜合設施；商場建築群

Practice 1

> A new **shopping complex** opened near the station.

車站附近開了一個新的**購物綜合設施**。

Practice 2

> The **shopping complex** includes restaurants and cinemas.

這個**購物中心**包括餐廳和戲院。

MCQ-ready definition:

shopping complex = 集合商店、餐飲和其他設施的大型商業建築群

11. **sports complex** — 體育綜合設施

Practice 1

> The university has a large **sports complex**.

大學有一個大型**體育綜合設施**。

Practice 2

> The new **sports complex** includes a pool and several courts.

新的**體育中心**包括泳池和數個球場。

MCQ-ready definition:

sports complex = 集合多種體育設施的建築或場地群

12. **residential complex** — 住宅屋苑；住宅建築群

Practice 1

> They live in a modern **residential complex**.

他們住在一個現代化**住宅屋苑**。

Practice 2

> The **residential complex** contains six apartment blocks.

這個**住宅建築群**有六幢大廈。

MCQ-ready definition:

residential complex = 多幢住宅及相關設施組成的建築群

13. **industrial complex** — 工業綜合區；工業建築群

Practice 1

> The factory is part of a large **industrial complex**.

工廠是一個大型**工業綜合區**的一部分。

Practice 2

> The **industrial complex** employs thousands of workers.

這個**工業建築群**僱用了數千名工人。

MCQ-ready definition:

industrial complex = 多間工廠或工業設施集中組成的區域

14. **complex** (心理：情結) — 情結；根深蒂固的心理感受

A major psychological noun sense.

Practice 1

> He developed a **complex** about his appearance.

他對自己的外貌產生了**心理情結**。

Practice 2

> She has a bit of a **complex** about speaking in public.

她對公開演講有點**心理包袱 / 情結**。

MCQ-ready definition:

complex = 一組強烈、持久，並影響一個人思想或行為的心理感受與觀念

15. **have a complex about something** — 對某事有心理包袱

Practice 1

> He has a **complex about his height**.

他對自己的身高有**心理包袱**。

Practice 2

> Don't develop a **complex about making mistakes**.

不要因為犯錯而形成**心理情結**。

MCQ-ready definition:

have a complex about X = 對 X 特別敏感、不安或缺乏自信

16. **inferiority complex** — 自卑情結

A very common fixed psychological expression.

Practice 1

> He developed an **inferiority complex** at school.

他在求學時期形成了**自卑情結**。

Practice 2

> An **inferiority complex** can affect confidence.

自卑情結可能影響自信。

MCQ-ready definition:

inferiority complex = 持續覺得自己比別人差或不如別人的強烈心理感受

17. **superiority complex** — **優越情結**

Practice 1

> His behaviour made him seem to have a **superiority complex**.

他的行為令他看起來好像有**優越情結**。

Practice 2

> A **superiority complex** can make teamwork difficult.

優越情結可能令團隊合作變得困難。

MCQ-ready definition:

superiority complex = 強烈覺得自己比別人優越，並在行為中表現出來的心理模式

18. **complexity** (**複雜性**) — **複雜性；複雜程度**

Practice 1

> The **complexity** of the problem requires teamwork.

問題的**複雜性**令團隊合作變得必要。

Practice 2

> Technology has increased the **complexity** of many jobs.

科技增加了很多工作的**複雜程度**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****complexity = 某件事包含很多互相關聯因素而變得難以理解或處理的程度****

19. ****the complexity of something — 某事的複雜性****

Practice 1

> Managers underestimated the ****complexity of the task****.

經理低估了這項任務的****複雜性****。

Practice 2

> We need to understand the ****complexity of the situation****.

我們需要理解這個情況的****複雜性****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****the complexity of X = X 有多少互相關聯因素及難以處理之處****

20. ****complexities — 複雜之處；錯綜因素****

Plural ****complexities**** often refers to the individual difficult aspects.

Practice 1

> The book explores the ****complexities of human relationships****.

這本書探討人際關係中的各種****複雜之處****。

Practice 2

> New employees need time to understand the ****complexities of the system****.

新員工需要時間理解系統中的各種****錯綜細節****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****complexities = 令某件事難以理解或處理的各個複雜因素****

21. **complex sentence — 複合句**

A major grammar term.

Practice 1

> This is a **complex sentence** containing a dependent clause.

這是一個包含從屬子句的**複合句**。

Practice 2

> IELTS writing often uses both simple and **complex sentences**.

IELTS 寫作通常同時使用簡單句和**複合句**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****complex sentence = 由一個獨立主句加至少一個從屬子句組成的句子****

Important:

complex sentence does not simply mean “a difficult sentence.”

It is a grammatical structure.

22. **complex number — 複數**

A major mathematical technical sense.

Practice 1

> A **complex number** can contain a real and an imaginary part.

****複數****可以包含實部和虛部。

Practice 2

> Students learn about **complex numbers** in mathematics.

學生在數學課學習****複數****。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****complex number = 可寫成 $a + bi$ 形式的數，其中 i 是虛數單位****

23. ****complex carbohydrate — 複合碳水化合物****

A common nutrition term.

Practice 1

> Whole grains contain ****complex carbohydrates****.

全穀類含有****複合碳水化合物****。

Practice 2

> Foods rich in ****complex carbohydrates**** are often digested more slowly.

含豐富****複合碳水化合物****的食物通常消化得較慢。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****complex carbohydrate = 由較長糖分子鏈組成的碳水化合物****

24. ****complex (science : 複合體) — 複合體****

An established scientific noun sense.

Practice 1

> The proteins form a ****complex****.

這些蛋白質形成一個****複合體****。

Practice 2

> Scientists studied the structure of the molecular ****complex****.

科學家研究了這個分子****複合體****的結構。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****complex = 科學上由兩個或以上相互結合的部分形成的整體****

25. **protein complex** — 蛋白質複合體

Practice 1

> The **protein complex** controls part of the process.

這個**蛋白質複合體**控制了部分過程。

Practice 2

> Several proteins combine to form the **complex**.

數種蛋白質結合形成這個**複合體**。

MCQ-ready definition:

protein complex = 由多個蛋白質分子互相結合形成的功能性組合

Important distinction 1: **complex** vs **complicated**

This is the most useful distinction.

complex

has many interconnected parts or factors.

complicated

is difficult to understand, use, or deal with.

They overlap strongly, but:

> a complex ecosystem

> 一個由很多互相關聯部分構成的生態系統

is especially natural because the parts interact.

> complicated instructions

> 難懂而繁瑣的指示

focuses more on difficulty.

Important distinction 2: **complex** does not always mean bad

A complex system may be:

- * sophisticated,
- * useful,
- * well designed.

So:

complex = many interconnected elements

not automatically:

badly designed

Important distinction 3: **complex vs difficult**

difficult

hard to do or understand.

complex

made of many interacting elements.

A task can be difficult but simple:

> lifting a very heavy object

Conceptually simple, physically difficult.

A system can be complex but familiar to an expert.

Important distinction 4: **complex vs detailed**

detailed

contains many individual pieces of information.

complex

those parts interact in ways that make the whole harder to understand.

A detailed list is not necessarily complex.

Important distinction 5: **complex vs sophisticated**

complex

many interconnected parts.

sophisticated

advanced, refined, or highly developed.

A sophisticated system is often complex, but **sophisticated** usually carries a more positive evaluation.

Important distinction 6: **complex problem vs complicated problem**

Both are possible.

complex problem

emphasizes multiple interacting causes.

complicated problem

emphasizes that solving it is difficult.

In your teamwork passage, **complex problems** is especially appropriate because product design and crisis management involve many departments, skills, and interacting factors.

Important distinction 7: **complexity vs difficulty**

complexity

number/interconnection of parts.

difficulty

how hard something is.

Higher complexity often creates difficulty, but they are not identical.

Important distinction 8: **complexity vs complexities**

complexity singular/uncountable:

the general quality of being complex.

> the complexity of teamwork

> 團隊合作的複雜性

complexities plural:

the individual complicated aspects.

> the complexities of teamwork

> 團隊合作中各種錯綜複雜之處

Important distinction 9: **complex as building group**

> office complex

does **not** mean:

> a complicated office

It means:

a group of connected or related office buildings

This is a completely different noun sense.

Important distinction 10: **complex as psychology**

> have a complex about your height

does not simply mean:

> think deeply about height.

It means:

have a persistent insecurity or psychologically sensitive concern about it

Important distinction 11: **inferiority complex vs low confidence**

low confidence

broad lack of confidence.

inferiority complex

more persistent pattern of feeling fundamentally less capable or valuable than others.

The latter is stronger and more psychological.

Important distinction 12: **superiority complex does not simply mean confidence**

confidence

belief in your abilities.

superiority complex

belief/behaviour suggesting you are above others.

So it usually carries a negative connotation.

Important distinction 13: **complex sentence**

A **complex sentence** can actually be very easy to understand:

> I left because I was tired.

This is grammatically complex because it contains:

* independent clause,

* dependent clause.

So:

complex sentence ≠ difficult sentence

Important distinction 14: **complex number**

Likewise:

complex number ≠ difficult number

Complex here is a fixed mathematical technical term.

Important distinction 15: **complex in science**

Scientific noun:

> a protein complex

means:

several components joined together into one functional unit

This is closer to the structural core of **complex** than to the everyday idea of “difficult.”

Family-extension note

Complex has a strong structural core:

made up of multiple connected or interacting parts

From this, several distinct modern branches developed:

1. **general complexity**

* complex problem

* complex system

* complex relationship

2. **building group**

- * office complex
- * sports complex
- * residential complex

3. **psychology**

- * have a complex
- * inferiority complex
- * superiority complex

4. **degree/quality**

- * complexity
- * complexities

5. **grammar**

- * complex sentence

6. **mathematics**

- * complex number

7. **nutrition**

- * complex carbohydrate

8. **science**

- * molecular/protein complex

For your passage, the exact meaning is:

complex = involving many interacting factors and therefore requiring multiple areas of expertise

Master comparison

Form / expression	Traditional Chinese	Core idea	
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complex (general)	複雜的	many interacting parts	
complex problem	複雜問題	many factors	
complex issue	複雜議題	multiple considerations	
complex system	複雜系統	interconnected parts	

complex process	複雜過程	many stages/interactions	
complex relationship	複雜關係	interacting factors	
increasingly complex	愈來愈複雜	growing complexity	
complex (building)	建築群；綜合設施	group of buildings	
shopping complex	購物綜合設施	commercial buildings	
sports complex	體育綜合設施	sports facilities	
residential complex	住宅屋苑 / 建築群	housing group	
industrial complex	工業綜合區	industrial facilities	
complex (psychology)	心理情結	persistent psychological concern	
inferiority complex	自卑情結	feeling inferior	
superiority complex	優越情結	feeling superior	
complexity	複雜性	quality/degree	
complexities	複雜之處	individual complications	
complex sentence	複合句	grammar	
complex number	複數	mathematics	
complex carbohydrate	複合碳水化合物	nutrition	
complex (science)	複合體	joined components	
protein complex	蛋白質複合體	biological unit	

For your original sentence

> As companies deal with increasingly **complex problems**, from product design to crisis management, they have come to rely heavily on group work...

Here:

**complex problems = 由很多互相關聯因素構成，而且往往需要不同專業知識共同處理的問題

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 隨着公司需要處理愈來愈**複雜、牽涉多方面因素的問題**，由產品設計到危機管理，它們愈來愈依賴團隊合作.....

The cleanest contrast is:

> **difficult** = 難

> **complicated** = 繁複、難懂 / 難處理

> **complex** = **由很多互相關聯的部分或因素構成**

For this passage, **complex** is especially precise because the argument is that such problems require **combined expertise from multiple people**, not simply that the problems are “hard.”